Lindsey McAllister

https://substack.com/@lindseymcal

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Privacy Software Engineer, Apple; Cupertino, CA — Aug 2021–Jul 2026

- Conceived and led privacy for protected apps (co-inventor on Apple's patent application), shipped on iOS: lets users lock any app with Face ID, hide it, and keep its data out of the rest of the system, including Apple Intelligence and Siri.
- Led privacy for on-device Apple Intelligence, designed the controls that govern how on-device intelligence and personalization features can use personal data
- Set privacy priorities, contributed to feature design, designed user-facing permission prompts and related API surface, conducted privacy reviews, and led responses to active privacy vulnerabilities for Location, Emergency Services, Apple Watch, Journal, Health, Find My, and Nearby Interactions
- Collaborated with Legal, Product Marketing, PR, Design, and Engineering leadership to determine product privacy guarantees and communicate them effectively to users
- Wrote standardized Apple-wide policy for user data collection (applies to ~5,000 internal requests/year) and privacy requirements for health studies (applies to ~100 studies/year involving >100,000 participants) to standardize decisioning and provide internal transparency into privacy requirements
- Wrote policies adopted by Privacy Steering Committee (includes C-suite leadership) regarding Apple-wide use of data collected without user consent, which paved the way for de-identifying analytics for Apple Services
- Represented iOS Privacy Improvements and Tools at WWDC 24 (Video)
- Developed system architecture, including cryptographic architecture and key management, memory, communication protocols, and applications of differential privacy and private federated learning for Ovulation Detection, Maps Visited Places and Learned Routes, Messages Check In (co-inventor on Apple's patent), Earthquake Alerts, Shared AirTags, and Apple-Google IETF standards proposal to reduce unwanted tracking risk (Video 51:03–1:10:10)

Researcher, MIT Internet Policy Research Initiative; Cambridge, MA — Jan–May 2021

- Wrote market analysis about consumer health data to understand players and incentives, ultimately contributing to privacy initiatives presented at the MIT AI Policy Forum

Software Engineering Intern, Google; Mountain View, CA — Jun–Aug 2019; Jun–Aug 2020

- Coded a Python tool to generate code required to enable commands for new services in GCloud command line interface, automating what was previously a 2–4 week task
- Developed a dashboard using Dart and Flutter running on Fuchsia (experimental operating system) to monitor daily build health of that operating system under development
- Received full-time return offer

Cybersecurity Consultant, MIT Cyber Clinic; Cambridge, MA — 2020

- Conducted assessment of cyber preparedness for the municipality of Pittsfield, MA and presented findings and recommendations to CIO and City Council

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology — B.S. Computer Science, Minor: Public Policy

- GPA: 4.9/5.0; Phi Beta Kappa (top 8% of students), Tau Beta Pi (top 12.5% of engineering students), and Eta Kappa Nu (top 25% of Computer Science students) Honor Societies
- Student Representative for MIT Dean's Group on the Social and Ethical Responsibilities of Computing; Arts & Innovation for Student Government; Amphibious Achievement (volunteer tutoring)
- Relevant Coursework: Foundations of Tech Policy; Science, Technology, and Public Policy; Computer Networking; Cybersecurity; Cryptography; Hardware Security; Machine Learning; Inference; Machine Learning and Political Science

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- Skills: System Design, Privacy-By-Design, Privacy-Enhancing Technologies, AI Privacy, Cryptography, Machine Learning, Networking, Python, Java, C++, Writing and Public Speaking
- Interests: Ethical Responsibilities of Computing, Reading, Political Theory, Running & Triathlons, Watercolor Painting